documentary constitution or a codified constitution. The constitutions of the USA, Canada, Japan, France and India are some of the good examples in this regard.

An unwritten constitution, on the other hand, is one in which most of the provisions are not incorporated in the form of a book or a document or a series of documents. It is found in the form of conventions, practices, principles, charters, statutes, and judicial decisions. It is a product of historical evolution and not deliberately formulated by a body. It is also known as a non-documentary constitution or an uncodified constitution and the constitutions of UK, New Zealand and Israel are the good examples in this regard.

The distinction between a written constitution and an unwritten constitution is more or less the same as is between an evolved constitution and an enacted constitution.

3. Rigid and Flexible

Based on the method of amendment, the constitutions are classified into rigid and flexible constitutions. This classification was given by Lord James Bryce[6].

A rigid constitution is one, which cannot be amended in the same manner as the ordinary laws. It requires a special procedure for its amendment. In other words, it makes a distinction between the constitutional law and the ordinary law. A flexible constitution, on the other hand, is one which can be amended in the same manner as the ordinary laws. It does not require a special procedure for its amendment. In other words, it does not make a distinction between the constitutional law and the ordinary law.

A flexible constitution is also known as an elastic constitution and the constitutions of UK and New Zealand are some good examples in this regard. A rigid constitution is also known as an inelastic constitution and the constitutions of the USA, Australia and Switzerland are some examples in this regard. The Constitution of India is neither rigid nor flexible, but a synthesis of both.

4. Federal and Unitary

Based on the nature of relationship between the national government and the regional governments, the constitutions are classified into federal and unitary constitutions. A federal constitution is one which provides for a division of power between the national government and the regional governments. It enables them to operate in their respective jurisdictions independently. A unitary constitution, on the other hand, is one which provides for the concentration of power in the hands of the national government. It makes the regional governments to operate as the subordinate agencies of the national government and exercise only such powers which may be delegated to them by the national government.

Federal constitution is prevalent in the USA, Switzerland, Australia, Canada, Russia, Brazil, and some other states. Unitary constitution is prevalent in the UK, France, Japan, China, Italy, Norway, and other states. The Constitution of India contains both the federal provisions as well as the unitary provisions. Hence, it was described as quasi-federal by K.C. Wheare.

5. Procedural and Prescriptive